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COMPUTER

CHAPTER 24

Social Media Platforms and Instant Messaging

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CHAPTER 24

Social Media Platforms and Instant Messaging

Computer Awareness

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Social media basics
- Major platforms
- Instant messaging
- Founders and ownership
- Marketing and communication
- Platform milestones

SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORM

A Social Media Platform is an online platform that allows users to create, share, and interact with content, connect with people, join communities, and communicate digitally.

Examples

- Facebook
- Instagram
- YouTube
- LinkedIn
- Snapchat

INSTANT MESSAGING (IM)

Instant Messaging refers to real-time communication between users through text, voice, video, images, or files using Internet-based applications.

Examples

- WhatsApp
- Telegram
- Signal
- Facebook Messenger

EVOLUTION OF SOCIAL MEDIA

Note for Students

SIXDEGREES

Founded :1997

Founder :Andrew Weinreich

Importance :Considered the world's first social networking site.

Exam Point :SixDegrees (1997) was the first social networking platform.

FACEBOOK

Meta Platforms

Founded :2004

Founder :Mark Zuckerberg

Parent company: Facebook, Inc. changed its corporate name to Meta Platforms in 2021; the Facebook app kept its name.

Meta Logo :∞ (Infinity Symbol)

Minimum Age :13 Years

Maximum Age :No age limit

Facebook MessengerLaunched in 2011 as a standalone app (original messaging features existed earlier inside Facebook).

Friend Limit :5000 Friends

CEO :Mark Zuckerberg

Exam Point: The parent company became Meta in 2021; Facebook remains the app’s name.

Facebook’s 2025 video rollout made uploaded videos reels without a universal length or format restriction. Photo-upload limits depend on the interface and feature.

Facebook Story clip limits depend on the format and app version; 20 seconds is not a universal fixed limit.

INSTAGRAM

Founded :2010

Founders

- Kevin Systrom
- Mike Krieger

Acquired By :Facebook (now Meta) in 2012 for approximately $1 billion.

Head of Instagram: Adam Mosseri (not a separate Instagram CEO).

Reels were introduced in 2020. The earlier 60-second Reel and 15-second Story limits are historical; duration limits depend on feature and app version.

Features

- Photo Sharing
- Reels
- Stories
- Live Streaming
- Messaging

Exam Point

Instagram was acquired by Facebook in 2012.

YOUTUBE

Founded :2005

Founders

- Chad Hurley
- Steve Chen
- Jawed Karim

CEO :Neal Mohan

Features

- Video Sharing
- Live Streaming
- Shorts
- Monetization

Exam Point :YouTube was founded in 2005 and later acquired by Google in 2006.

LINKEDIN

Founded :2003

Co-founder: Reid Hoffman (with other co-founders)

Acquired By :Microsoft (2016)

Headquarters :Sunnyvale

CEO: Dan Shapero (appointed in April 2026).

Purpose: Professional networking and job searching.

Exam Point :LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform.

WHATSAPP

Founded :2009

Founders

- Brian Acton
- Jan Koum

Programming Language :Erlang Acquired By :Meta (Facebook) in 2014.

Head :Will Cathcart

Features

- Text Messaging
- Voice Calling
- Video Calling
- Status Updates
- File Sharing
- End-to-End Encryption

WhatsApp Business :Launched in 2018.

WhatsApp Status video duration limits vary with app updates; the old 30-second limit is not a permanent limit.

The earlier limit of 30 photos per send is outdated; supported upload limits depend on the app version and interface.

Whatsapp group has max 1024 participants

WhatsApp supports group voice and video calls with up to 32 participants.

WhatsApp Pay :First launched in Brazil in 2020.

Group Limit :Up to 1024 participants.

Exam Point :WhatsApp uses End-to-End Encryption by default.

SIGNAL

Signal app: launched in 2014. Signal Foundation: established in 2018.

Signal Foundation founders (2018)

- Brian Acton
- Moxie Marlinspike

Organization :Signal Foundation Focus :Privacy and Secure Communication

Exam Point :Signal is known for strong privacy protection.

TELEGRAM

Founded :2013

Founders

- Pavel Durov
- Nikolai Durov

Headquarters :Dubai

CEO :Pavel Durov

Group Size :Up to 200,000 Members

Features

- Cloud Messaging
- Large Groups
- Channels
- Bots

Exam Point :Telegram supports one of the largest group capacities among messaging apps.

SNAPCHAT

Founded :2011

Founders

- Evan Spiegel
- Bobby Murphy
- Reggie Brown

CEO :Evan Spiegel

Features

- Disappearing Messages
- Stories
- AR Filters
- Snap Map

Exam Point

Snapchat popularized disappearing messages and stories.

SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING (SMM)

Social Media Marketing (SMM) is the use of social media platforms to advertise products, services, brands, or organizations.

Examples

- Facebook Ads
- Instagram Ads
- YouTube Ads
- LinkedIn Ads

Exam Point

SMM = Social Media Marketing

INSTANT MESSAGING (IM)

Instant Messaging is a technology that allows users to communicate in real time through text, voice, video, and file sharing. Features

✔ Real-Time Communication

✔ Group Chats

✔ Voice Calls

✔ Video Calls

✔ File Sharing

End-to-end encryption is offered by some messaging services or modes; it is not universal in instant messaging.

Client-Server Model in Instant Messaging

Most instant messaging applications use a Client-Server Model.

ICQ (I Seek You)

Launched :1996

Company :Mirabilis

Acquired By :AOL (America Online) in 1998.

Importance

One of the first popular Instant Messaging applications.

MOST POPULAR SOCIAL MEDIA & MESSAGING PLATFORMS

IN INDIA

Examples of widely used platforms in India (this list is not a verified active-user ranking):

1.WhatsApp

2.Instagram

3.Facebook 4.Telegram

5.Facebook Messenger

Exam Point

WhatsApp is the most widely used messaging platform in India.

SOCIAL MEDIA VS INSTANT MESSAGING

Feature	Social Media	Instant Messaging
Purpose	Content Sharing	Direct Communication
Communication	One-to-Many	One-to-One / Group
Examples	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube	WhatsApp, Signal, Telegram
Main Use	Social Networking	Real-Time Messaging

TIMELINE OF MAJOR PLATFORMS

1996 → ICQ

1997 → SixDegrees

2003 → LinkedIn

2004 → Facebook

2005 → YouTube

2009 → WhatsApp

2010 → Instagram

2011 → Snapchat

2013 → Telegram 2014 → Signal

MOST IMPORTANT FACTS FOR EXAMS

1.SixDegrees (1997) was the first social networking platform.

2.Facebook was founded by Mark Zuckerberg in 2004.

3.Facebook’s parent company changed its name to Meta in 2021; the app remained Facebook.

4.Instagram was founded in 2010.

5.Instagram was acquired by Facebook in 2012.

6.YouTube was founded in 2005.

7.LinkedIn was founded in 2003.

8.LinkedIn was acquired by Microsoft.

9.WhatsApp was founded by Brian Acton and Jan Koum.

10.WhatsApp uses Erlang programming language.

11.WhatsApp was acquired by Meta in 2014.

12.Telegram was founded by Pavel and Nikolai Durov.

13.Signal focuses on privacy and security.

14.Snapchat was founded by Evan Spiegel, Bobby Murphy, and Reggie Brown.

15.ICQ stands for "I Seek You."

16.ICQ was launched in 1996.

17.SMM stands for Social Media Marketing.

18.Instant messaging generally follows the Client-Server Model.

QUICK REVISION NOTES (1-MINUTE REVISION)

- SixDegrees (1997) = First social networking site.
- ICQ (1996) = Early instant messenger.
- Facebook founded by Mark Zuckerberg (2004).
- Meta = New name of Facebook company (2021).
- Instagram founded by Kevin Systrom and Mike Krieger (2010).
- YouTube founded by Chad Hurley, Steve Chen, and Jawed Karim (2005).
- LinkedIn was launched in 2003; Reid Hoffman was one of its co-founders.
- WhatsApp founded by Brian Acton and Jan Koum (2009).
- Telegram founded by Pavel and Nikolai Durov (2013).
- Signal founded by Moxie Marlinspike (2014).
- Snapchat founded by Evan Spiegel, Bobby Murphy, and Reggie Brown (2011).
- SMM = Social Media Marketing.
- IM = Instant Messaging.
- WhatsApp, Signal, Telegram = Messaging Apps.
- Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, LinkedIn = Social Media Platforms.